little that we can depend upon in the way of progress toward effective development or, indeed, political legitimacy.

There are many other points that our particular report makes, but an important and I think significant point related to the purpose of the hearing is that Afghanistan cannot be considered as an isolated state that we can deal with on its own. That has not been true for a very long time; it is even less true now. It is vulnerable as never before to external pressure. And what goes on, particularly as we said 4 months ago, in the Pakistan border region is critical to success of failure.

Kabul and the government there have to have better relations with their neighbors, but particularly with Pakistan. And the commitment on the Pakistani part to deal with the tribal areas in the Federally Administered Territories is something that is particularly challenging and elusive, and your focus on it I believe is correct and important and lies at one of the centers of the way forward, if I can call it that, if it can be corrected.

We made several recommendations. I want to repeat just a few of those as further background for the close interrelationship between the problems in Afghanistan, the Tribal Areas, and in Pakistan. One of those goes to the heart of what we have been saying back and forth to each other across this table this morning. We felt it was important to create a group, perhaps eminent persons from among our allies and our partners, to work together with the Afghans to put together this long-term coherent strategy. It would be a strategy that would attempt to reflect intimate knowledge of Afghanistan, not necessarily to be made in one of the partner countries or the United States, but bring to bear the full efforts that all of those parties can collect together to deal with this issue.

We think it is important to decouple in this country legislative and executive branch consideration of Iraq and Afghanistan. Up until now Afghanistan has slid into the debate and indeed the question of funding in Iraq as what we used to know in the Uniform Code of Military Justice as a lesser included offense. In a way, this needs obviously to stand on its own to get the kind of attention and focus that I know you and the committee would like to bring to it.

And finally, we believe there needs to be a more coherent, more structured, more unified United States effort, perhaps around a specially appointed person to deal with Afghanistan, the border regions, and at least the Afghan-related problems of Pakistan. That person needs to be high in the administration, closely coordinating our activities, and helping in fact to execute the plan that we talked about.

We need greater consolidation, I believe, of our military efforts. And I will let General Jones talk about that. We do need, we believe, more forces on the ground. But even more importantly, as Dick pointed out, when we and our forces are successful we leave behind a security mission that cannot yet be performed either by the Afghan National Army or by the Afghan police. Particularly the latter, at least the experts in our committee believed, requires a great deal of reinforcement and training. They are far below the standard that they need to achieve to have any capacity in fact to deal with the continuing security problems after military engagement while in fact rebuilding and reconstruction takes place. The United States could and should play a larger role in dealing with the Afghan National Police.

We need a coherent and resource strategy to build the capacity and the legitimacy of the Afghan Government. This means tackling tough issues of corruption. And in that country it will not be easy. But we need to begin by developing pockets of competence in the country,

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